3. Interview with Dinesh Sharma, deputy chief minister, UP; former vice president, BJP; former BJP in-charge, Gujarat; and ex-mayor, Lucknow, 8 June 2020, Lucknow.
4. Diego Maiorana, 'The 2019 Indian elections and the ruralization of the BJP', *Studies in Indian Politics*, Vol. 7, No. 2, 2019, pp. 177, 183.
5. Similarly, in the 2021 West Bengal assembly elections where the BJP, with 77 of 294 seats, came a distant second to Trinamool Congress, the majority of its wins were in the state's rural and rurban constituencies. Of the BJP's 77 seats, as many as 58 (75.3 per cent) were rural or rurban, 38 (49.3 per cent) rural and 20 (25.9 per cent) rurban. TOI Data Hub: https://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/elections/assembly-elections/west-bengal/constituency-map. Note: Results were declared on 2 May 2021 for 292 seats (as polls in two seats were postponed due to the death of candidates).
6. Interview with Jai Mrug, CEO, M76 Analytics and Director, VotersMood Research, 21 and 28 May 2020.
7. Ibid.
8. Ibid.

CHAPTER 3 The Caste Game

1. Akhilesh Singh, 'Modi hails BJP workers for "Seva Yagna" in Covid times', *The Times of India*, 5 July 2019.
2. If you leave out BJP MPs elected from seats reserved by law only for SC or ST, the party still had 113 OBC and a further nineteen MPs who were either SC or ST who got elected from 226 general constituencies. Among reserved constituencies, BJP won thirty-one of the forty-seven ST-reserved seats nationwide with 41.7 per cent vote share, and forty-six of the eighty-four SC-reserved seats with 35.3 per cent vote share across India. Analysis by author from ECI data and SC/ST seat analysis is available at: https://pollniti.com/live.html#.
3. Christophe Jaffrelot, *Modi's India: Hindu Nationalism and the Rise of Ethnic Democracy* (New Delhi: Context, 2021), first published Princeton University Press, 2021, pp. 344-346. Jaffrelot is regarded as the preeminent global scholar of the Hindu nationalist